002. Al-Baqara ~ The Cow

286 Ayaat (Madani)

FOCUS

TIMELESS RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR GUIDANCE IN SURATUL FATIHA
UNDERSTANDING FAITH THROUGH HISTORY
GUIDANCE THROUGH PRACTICAL LAWS AND DIRECTIVES
FROM DIVINITY COVERING ALL MATTERS
AYATUL KURSI - AWESOMENESS OF ALLAH

DID YOU KNOW?

IT IS THE LONGEST SURA OF THE QUR'AN COMPRISING ONE TWELFTH OF THE ENTIRE TEXT
"EVERYTHING HAS A ZENITH AND THE ZENITH OF THE QUR'AN IS SURATUL BAQARA AND IN IT IS THE BEST OF VERSES – AYATUL KURSI (THE VERSE OF THE THRONE).
HOLDING TO IT IS A BLESSING AND LEAVING IT IS AN AFFLICTION"
Prophet Muhammad (pbuh)

SELECTED AYAAT

2:129 Dua of Prophet Ibraheem (pbuh) answered in 62:2
2:148 Direction (Goal)
2:156 Indeed we are from Allah and to Him we shall surely return
2:158 Safa and Marwa
2:173 Forbidden meat
2:177 Ayatul Birr What it means to be a good person
2:144 Qibla
2:183 Fasting (Sawm)
2:186 Dua
2:201 Dua for good in the world and the hereafter
2:207 Ali (pbuh) in hijra
2:219 Intoxicants and gambling
2:222 Menstruation
2:255 Ayatul Kursi Aya of the throne (Sayyidul Ayaat - Leader of all the ayaat)
2:264 Charity
2:285 Aamanar Rasul

NARRATIVE

It is the longest chapter of the Qur'an and opens with the answer to the question in Sura Al Fatiha of "Guide us on the right way" stating that this is the guidance for the God conscious.
It begins with the categorisation of belief into those who believe in the seen and unseen, all the prophets and the imperative to give followed by those who cover up the truth and then hypocrisy.

Then starts a historical journey of belief from the creation of Prophet Adam and the refusal of Shaitan to obey the order of Divinity to prostrate to him.
This is followed by the history of the children of Israail; the numerous blessings given to them and milestone events in their history.
Prophet Ibraheem is discussed next in his establishment of the Ka'ba and his prayer for peace, prosperity, a Prophet from his progeny. The change of qibla from Jerusalem to the Ka'ba follows and then important practical laws are legislated in this chapter.

Long term financial investments of condition free loans to humanity, charity without reproach and the chief of the verses of the Qur'an - Ayatul Kursi follow. Here the awesomeness of Allah is described.
The chapter ends with a re-iteration of core beliefs and a prayer of forgiveness, protection and help to maintain them.